AFFAIRSCLOUD - TOPPERS CA

Read Smart, Score High.

One News.
Four Transformations.

06 Nov 2026 – ENG

Learn it. Understand it. Remember it. Master it.

1 HAND WRITTEN NOTES



- Structured Notes
- Better Recall
- Quick Revision



ONE NEWS
Raw Information

2 LEARN FROM PICTURE



- Visual Learning
- Stronger Memory
- Better Understanding

3 DAILY CONTENT PDF



India assumes Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time; appoints Vivek Agrawal

In June 2025, India was elected as Vice-President of the Financial Task Force (FATF) for the first time. This reflects India's commitment to global standards in combating money laundering and terrorist financing.

Exam Hint:

- **What:** Vice-Presidency of FATF for the first time
- **Who:** Vivek Agrawal
- **Body:** Financial Action Task Force (FATF)
- **Term:** July 2025 to June 2027
- **Significance:** Helps build trust and recognition.

PDF

- Complete Coverage
- Exam Hint Focused
- Instant Revision



SMART LEARNING
BETTER PREPARATION

HIGHER SCORES
SUCCESS

4 DAILY QUIZ



- Exam Level MCQs
- Instant Revision
- Track Performance

YOUR COMPLETE CA RESOURCE LIBRARY

DAILY
- Daily CA PDF
- Daily CA Quiz
- Learn from Picture PDF

WEEKLY
- Top 60 Quiz
- Weekly PDF

MONTHLY
- Top 100 Quiz
- Pocket PDF
- Study PDF
- Exam PDF
- Banking & Economy PDF

This **PAID PDF** is provided by AffairsCloud's dedicated team that works diligently to provide aspirants with high-quality content. We recommend you to purchase this PDF subscription and seize the opportunity to learn efficiently.

Help Us to Grow & Provide Quality Service



[Click here to Download the CareersCloud APP]

[Click here to Join the Telegram Channel]

[Current Affairs Channel]

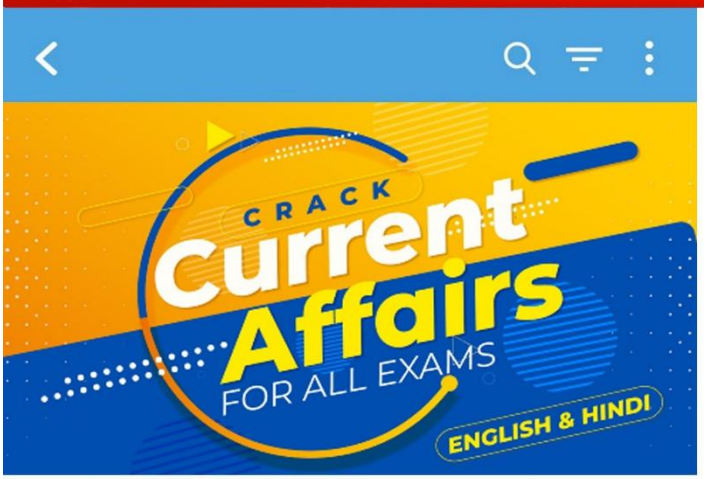
[AffairsCloud Hindu Vocabs]

Suggestions & Feedback are welcomed

Support@careerscloud.in

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com





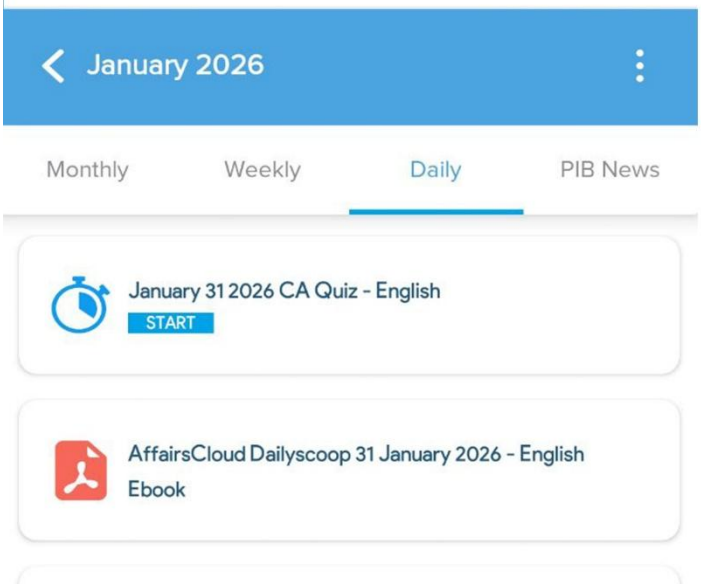
Crack Current Affairs 2026 PDF

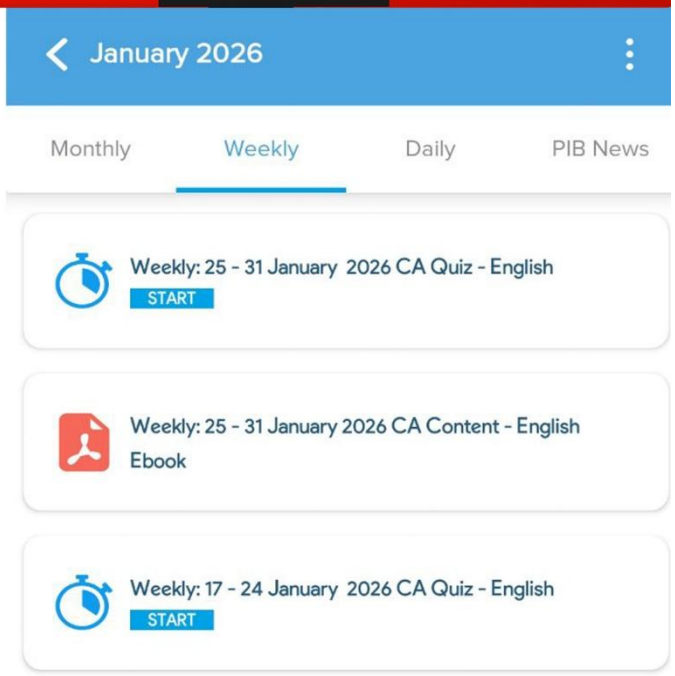
Bank & Insurance

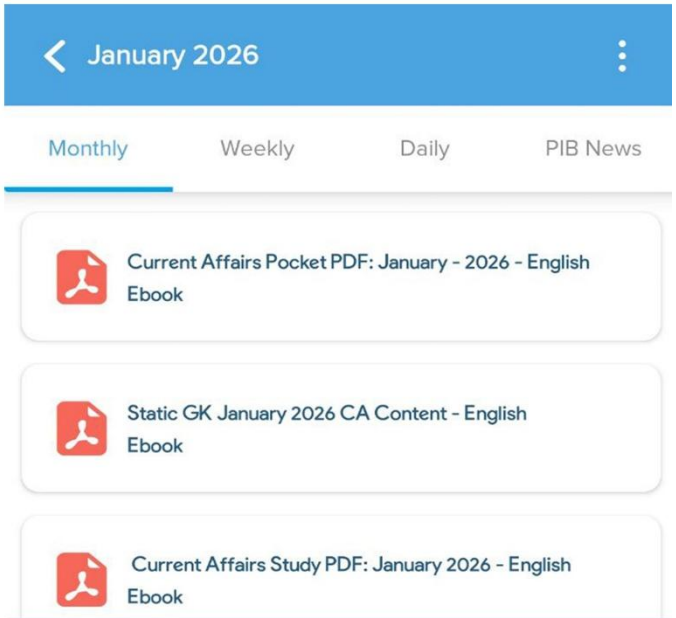
Created by : CareersCloud

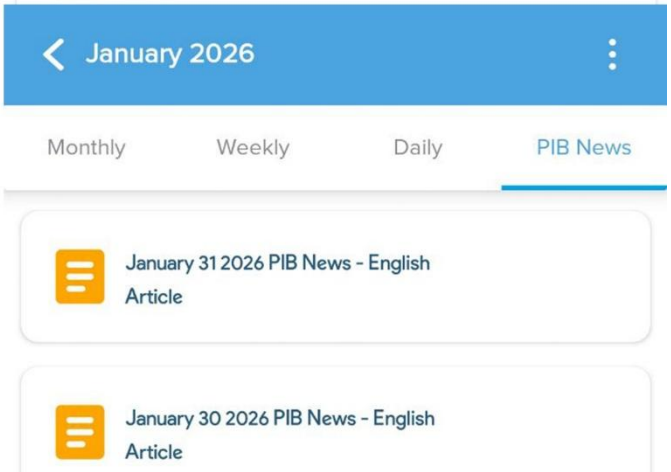
Path | Articles | Videos | Quizzes

- Current Affairs English
- Current Affairs Hindi
- Banking Awareness
- CA Exam PDF
- Special CA
- General









AFFAIRSCLOUD TODAY

Table of Contents

HandWritten Notes 5

Detailed Content 15

Important Notice: CareersCloud Content Sharing and Legal Compliance

We kindly request our aspirants **not to share or distribute our content, PDFs, videos, or any other materials under our ownership to individuals or through any social media platforms**. Please note that we have implemented a tracking system to monitor such activities. Any violation of this policy may result in the immediate termination of access to our services, and we will not be held responsible for any loss or inconvenience caused due to such actions. Furthermore, we also reserve the right to take strict legal action, including filing complaints under applicable laws, against individuals or entities found violating this policy.

🎉 **Congratulations on Your Success!**

If you have successfully cleared the examination, we invite you to submit your details for official recognition by our community. Your achievement represents dedication, discipline, and excellence and it deserves to be celebrated.

Selected candidates will be:

- Featured on our Official Achievers List
- Highlighted across our digital platforms
- Recognised as community role models

📱 **Scan the QR Code to submit your Details or 👉 Click the below link:**

https://forms.gle/xbxExzt1ETcPMfFZ7

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

HandWritten Notes

Please Let us Know your Feedback –  **Click here to give Rating**

NATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

Union Cabinet Chaired by PM Narendra Modi → Approved → VISTAR Scheme 4 November 2026 → Outlay → Rs. 4,371.10 Crore → To → Modernise India's Statistical System

Scheme details:

- Scheme Type: Central Sector Scheme (CSS)
- Implementation Period: FY27–FY31 (5 Years)
- Nodal Ministry: MoSPI
- Vision: Viksit Bharat 2047

Three major components

1. Comprehensive Statistical Operations
   - Survey Expansion: 59 Surveys (Earlier 43)
   - Digital Transformation: AI & ML Integration
   - Focus: Data Collection, Validation, Analysis & Dissemination
2. Support for Statistical Strengthening (SSS 2.0)
   - Coverage: States & Union Territories
   - Focus: District & Million-Plus City-Level Statistical Estimates
   - Key Indicators: PLFS, HCES, ASUSE, GDP & IIP
3. Eighth Economic Census
   - Implementation: MoSPI with State & UT Governments
   - Coverage: Gram Panchayat & Ward Levels
   - Purpose: Baseline for National Statistical Business Register (SBR)

VISTAR– Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research
MoSPI – Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation
FY – Financial Year
AI/ML – Artificial Intelligence/ Machine Learning
PLFS – Periodic Labour Force Survey
HCES – Household Consumption Expenditure Survey
ASUSE– Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises
CPI – Consumer Price Index
GDP – Gross Domestic Product
IIP – Index of Industrial Production

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

2)

i)

Union Cabinet —Approved→ Rs 14,500 crore VGF Scheme —For→ Development of 92 GWh Grid-Scale Energy Storage Systems → For Period of 5 years (FY27 to FY31)

🔋 Grid-Scale Energy Storage Scheme:

🎯 Target: 92 GWh additional storage capacity:

- 60 GWh – Pumped Storage Projects (PSPs).
- 30 GWh – Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS).
- 2 GWh – Alternative storage technologies.

🏗️ Investment: Rs. 97,600 crore.

📊 Capacity Goal: 170% of current capacity; achieve 411 GWh by FY32.

⚙️ Implementation: Competitive bidding; public/private DISCOMs; 40% BESS domestic content and Renewable integration with 24 x 7 supply

ii)

Union Cabinet —Approved→ Capex Support Scheme —To Promote→ Rs. 2,814 crore for domestic Lithium and Nickel processing units → For 5 Years (FY27–FY31).

🏭 Units: 2 Lithium (30,000 tonnes each) and 2 Nickel (50,000 tonnes each).

💸 Subsidy: 30% of investment.

📌 Maximum Support: Rs. 500 crore (Lithium) and Rs. 900 crore (Nickel) per beneficiary.

♻️ Cobalt: Recovery as a by-product of nickel processing.

🎯 Key Sectors: Mobility, BESS, electronics, defence and steel.

VGF – Viability Gap Funding

GWh – Gigawatt-hour

DISCOM – Distribution Company

Capex – Capital Expenditure

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

3)

i)

Union Cabinet —Approved→ Rs. 3,788.04 Crore for Continuation of FTSC Scheme including POCSO Courts —For→ 5 Years till March 2031

- 🎯 Objective: Time-bound trials and reduced pendency of rape and POCSO cases.
- 📈 Expansion: 779 to 850 FTSCs.
- 💵 Funding: Centre – Rs. 2,353.15 crore (Nirbhaya Fund); States/UTs – Rs. 1,434.89 crore.
- 👧 Victim Support: Vulnerable Witness Deposition Centres (VWDC) and child-friendly courts.

📊 Monitoring: FTSC Dashboard, progress reports and expenditure statements.

About FTSC:

🗓️ Launch: 2 October 2019, following the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2018.

🏛️ Ministry: Department of Justice, Ministry of Law and Justice.

ii)

Cabinet —Approved→ 2-year Extension —For→ 75 % of Agniveers after initial 4-year service

> 🪖 Enrolment: Regular service after 6 years; existing 25% selection after 4 years retained.
> 💰 Benefits: Higher pay, Seva Nidhi and seniority.

FTSC – Fast Track Special Court

POCSO – Protection of Children from Sexual Offences

UT – Union Territory

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

4)

1st International Maize Conference 2026 —Held→ Hyderabad, Telangana —On→ 2–4 November 2026

- 🎯 Theme: "Maize Revolution for Food, Feed, Fodder, Fuel and Sustainability in the Changing World (M4FS)"
- 🏛️ Organisers: Jointly organised by MTAI, PJTAU, ICAR, TAAS, CIMMYT and ICAR-IIMR.
- 📊 Production: India produces around 55 million tonnes (MT) of maize, targeting 75 MT over the next decade.
- 👩‍🌾 Framework: Traditional 4F (Food, Feed, Fodder and Fuel) expanded to 5F by adding Farmers.
- 🏅 Awards: ICAR and MTAI recognised scientists for contributions to germplasm conservation, climate-resilient breeding and agronomy.
- IN India's Position: Ranks 4th globally in maize cultivation area; major producing states include Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Bihar, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Telangana.

MTAI – Maize Technologists Association of India

PJTAU – Professor Jayashankar Telangana Agricultural University

ICAR – Indian Council of Agricultural Research

TAAS – Trust for Advancement of Agricultural Sciences

CIMMYT – International Maize and Wheat Improvement Center

IIMR – Indian Institute of Maize Research

5)

IndiaAI Mission (MeitY) —Released→ Indigenous AI Foundation Models EKA-1, Dhir 2B and Dhir 5B

↓ 🏢 Developed by

Soket Labs Technology and ZenteiQ AITech Innovations.

- 🧠 EKA-1: 26.3 billion parameters; supports 22 Indian languages and English.
- 🔵 Dhir 2B & 5B: Open-source models supporting English and 10 Indian languages.
- 🖥️ Deployment: GPUs, TPUs and mobile devices; offline AI.
- 🔐 Support: IndiaAI infrastructure, funding and AIKosh.

AI – Artificial Intelligence

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

MeitY – Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

GPU – Graphics Processing Unit

TPU – Tensor Processing Unit

6)

TRAI —Launched→ Network Anubhav Platform (Geospatial dashboard) —For→ Telecom network monitoring

Aim
Improve telecom network transparency and service quality

Data
Integrates MySpeed, MyCall and IDT data

Features
Compares network coverage, internet speed and call quality; supports reports and third-party speed testing

TRAI – Telecom Regulatory Authority of India

IDT – Independent Drive Test

7)

IICA + IAMC (Hyderabad, Telangana) —Signed→ MoU —Strengthen→ India's Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) ecosystem & improve Ease of Doing Business

Capacity Building: Train arbitrators and mediators, with specialised mediation support for the MSME sector.

Abbreviations

IICA	—	Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs
IAMC	—	International Arbitration and Mediation Centre
MoU	—	Memorandum of Understanding
ADR	—	Alternative Dispute Resolution
MSME	—	Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

1)

The Commonwealth of the Bahamas —Joined→ International Solar Alliance (ISA) —As→ 116th Member Country

✍ Accession: Submitted during the 9th ISA Assembly in New Delhi, Delhi

🌍 Benefits: Promotes solar deployment through knowledge-sharing, technical assistance, joint initiatives and funding access, particularly for LDCs and SIDS..

International Solar Alliance (ISA):

🏛 Established: India and France jointly launched ISA in 2015 at COP21, Paris.

COP – Conference of the Parties

LDCs – Least Developed Countries

SIDS – Small Island Developing States

BANKING & FINANCE

1)

RBI —Constituted→ Technical Consultative Committee for Financial Markets (TCCFM) —To address→ Financial market policy & operational issues

👤 Chairman: Rohit Jain, RBI Deputy Governor

📋 Functions: Review market liquidity, efficiency, resilience, trading, clearing, settlement and emerging risks

🗓 Meetings: At least once every quarter

RBI Eases Foreign Exchange Reporting Requirements

📬 Amendment: FEMA (Foreign Exchange Management) Regulations, 2026; effective 1 October 2026.

🏢 Non-Individuals: EDF exemption for service export receipts up to Rs. 10 lakh

👤 Individuals: Service exporters deemed to have submitted EDF after sharing payment details with AD banks.

📥 Imports: AD banks must report eligible service imports in IDPMS within 5 working days.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

RBI – Reserve Bank of India

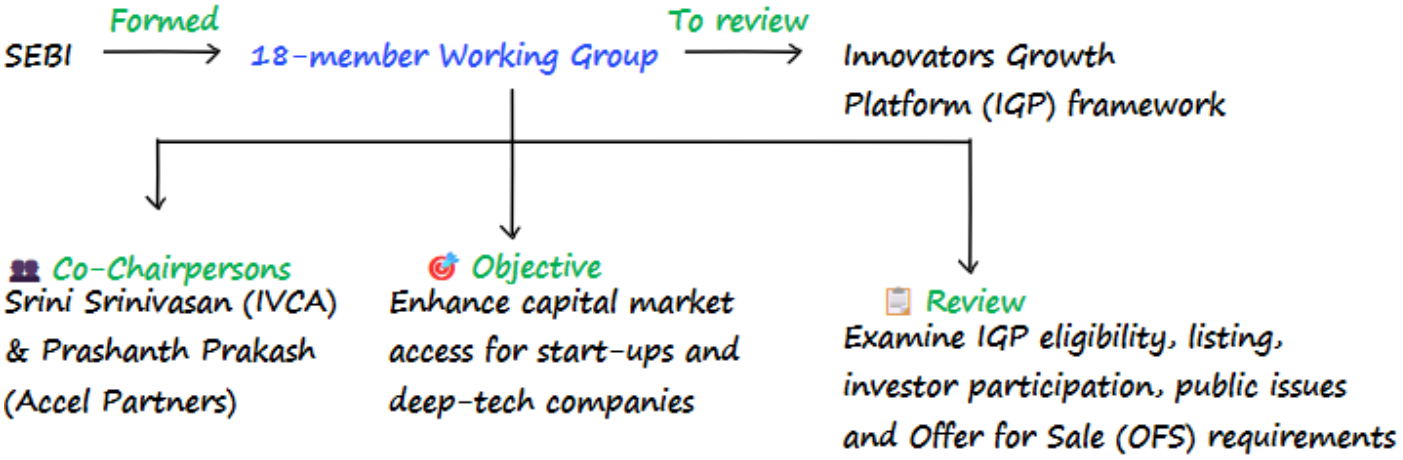
FEMA – Foreign Exchange Management Act

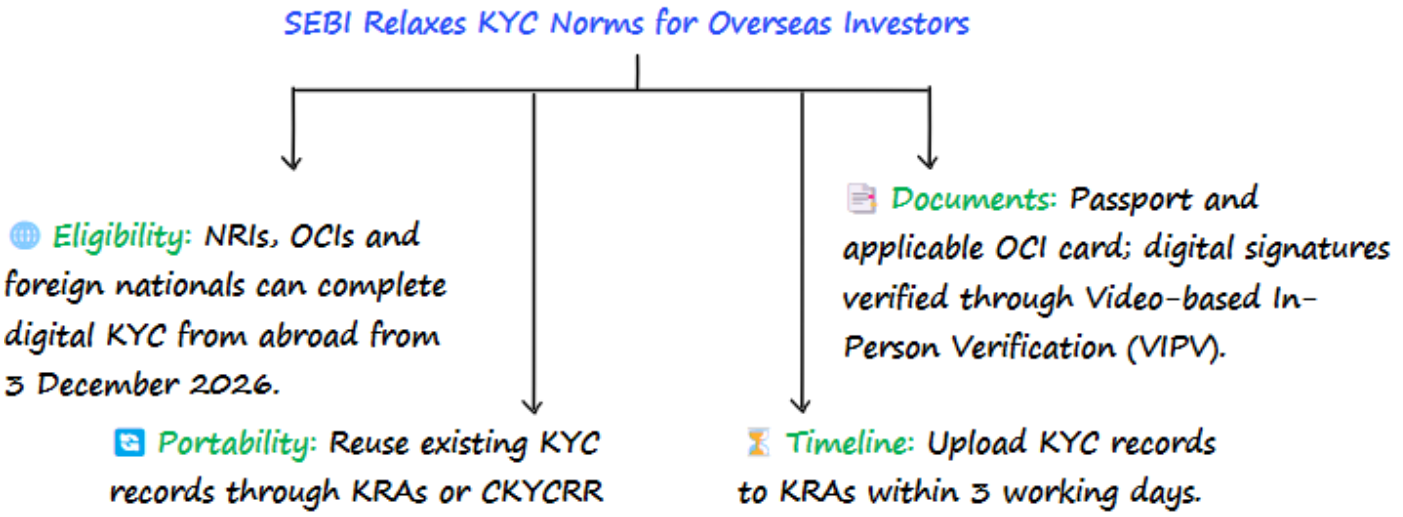
EDF – Export Declaration Form

AD – Authorised Dealer

IDPMS – Import Data Processing and Monitoring System

2)





Note:

CKYC Number: A unique 14-digit identifier generated by CKYCRR after a customer's KYC registration.

SEBI – Securities and Exchange Board of India

IVCA – Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association

KYC – Know Your Customer

NRI – Non-Resident Indian

OCI – Overseas Citizen of India

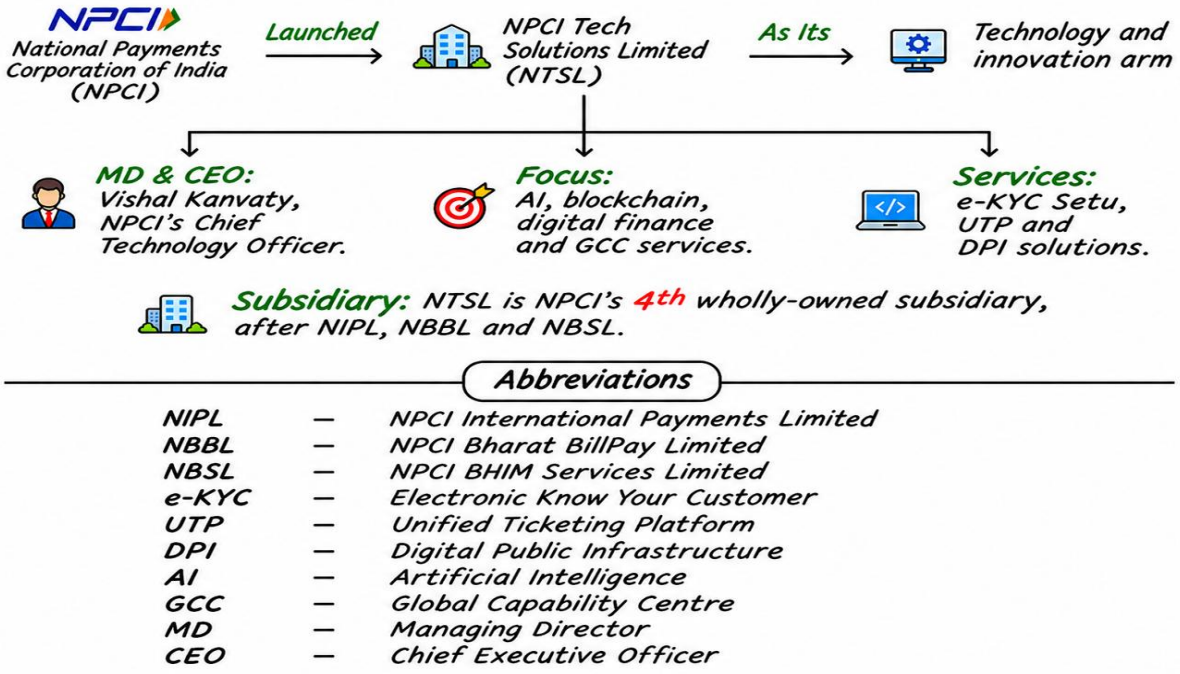
KRA – KYC Registration Agency

CKYCRR – Central KYC Records Registry

 Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

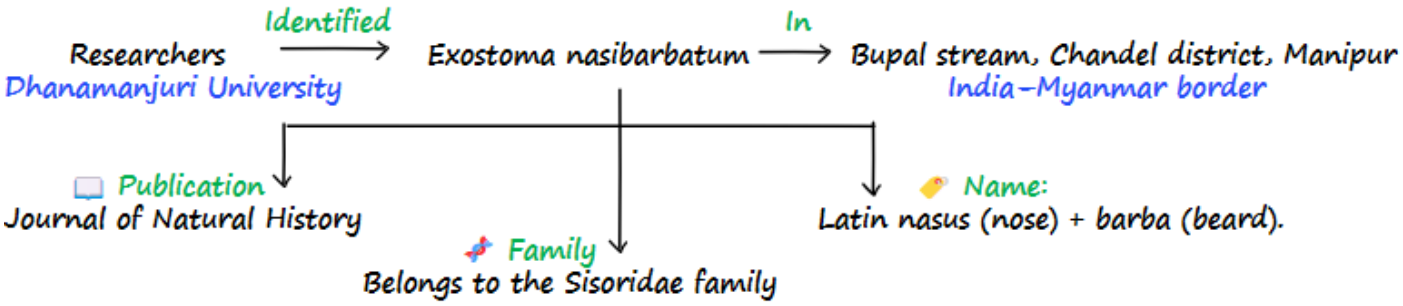
CKYC - Central Know Your Customer

3)



ENVIRONMENT

1)



 Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

OBITUARY

1)

Alan Stanley Jones — Passed Away in → Australia — At Age → 80 Years — Won → 1980 F1 Drivers' Championship

Championship Achievements

- **Australian Milestone:** Second Australian F1 World Champion, after Sir Jack Brabham
- **Williams Racing:** First Drivers' Championship Winner
- **1980 Season:** 5 Grand Prix (GP) Victories
- **Career Record:** 116 Race Starts & 12 Grand Prix Victories

Awards & Honours

- **1980** – Member of the Order of the British Empire (MBE)
- **1985** – Inducted into Sport Australia Hall of Fame

Abbreviations

F1 – Formula One

2)

Nand Lal → Former SPG Commando & 4 time HP's MLA

- Born: Himachal Pradesh (HP)
- Passed Away at 72

- **SPG Service:** 1985–1997; protected Sonia Gandhi.
- **Elections:** Won Rampur seat in 2007, 2012, 2017 and 2022.
- **Awards:** President's Police Medals for Meritorious Service (2001) and Distinguished Service

SPG – Special Protection Group

MLA – Member of the Legislative Assembly

IMPORTANT DAYS

1)

International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, Including Cyberbullying — Observed On → 5 November 2026 (First Thursday of November) — By → UNESCO — For → Safe Schools, Teacher Support & Reporting Systems

- **Theme:** "Every learner safe and well: From promise to practice"
- **First Observance:** 5 November 2020

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

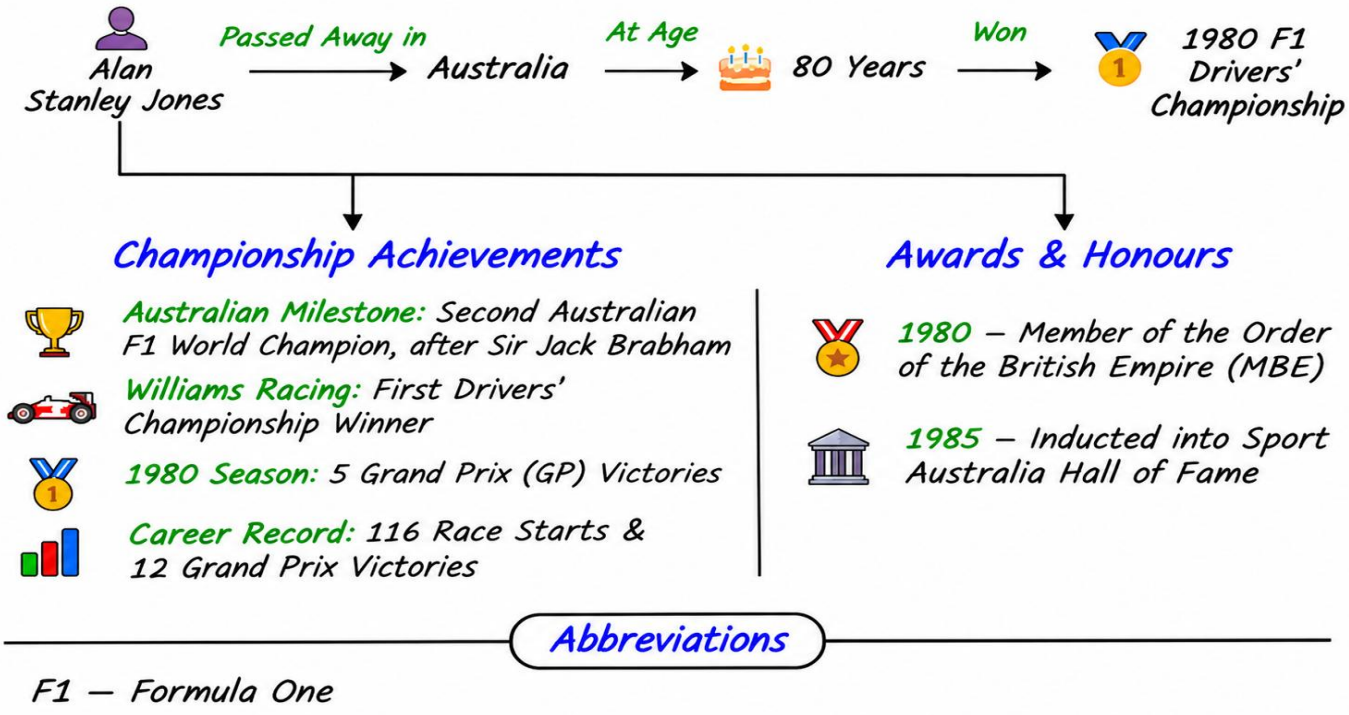
UNESCO – United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

2)



STATE NEWS

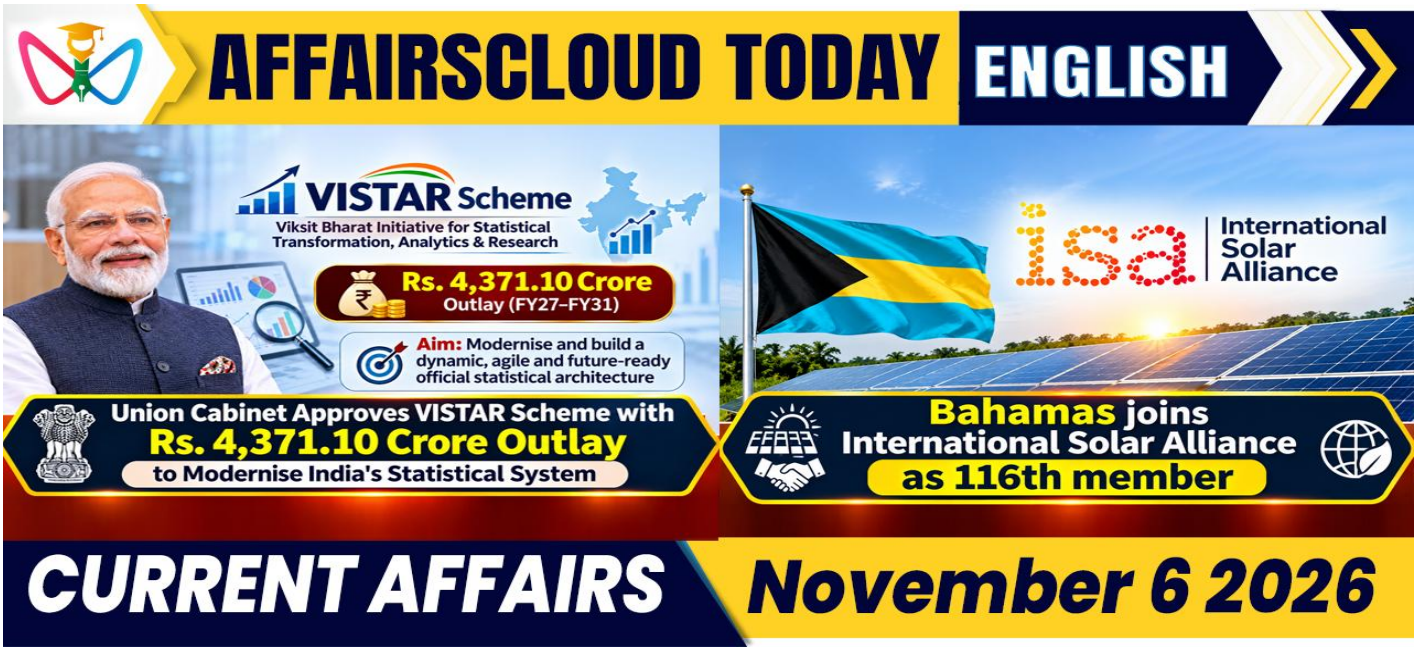
1)



Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Detailed Content

Current Affairs 6 November 2026: Headlines



- Union Cabinet Approves Rs. 4,371.10 Crore VISTAR Scheme to Modernise India's Statistical System
- Cabinet Approves Rs 14,500 crore VGF Scheme for development of 92 GWh Grid-Scale Energy Storage Systems
- Cabinet Approves Rs. 3,788.04 Crore for Continuation of Fast Track Special Courts Scheme for 5 Years till March 2031
- 1st International Maize Conference 2026 Held in Hyderabad to Strengthen Maize Productivity and Sustainability
- IndiaAI Mission Releases Indigenous AI Foundation Models EKA-1, Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B
- TRAI Launches 'Network Anubhav' Platform to Monitor Network Performance
- IICA Signs MoU with IAMC to Strengthen India's Alternative Dispute Resolution Ecosystem
- Bahamas Joins International Solar Alliance as 116th Member Country
- RBI Constitutes TCCFM to Focus on Financial markets, Eases Reporting Requirement for Small Service Exporters and Importers
- SEBI Sets Up Panel to Ease Market Access for Startups, Deep-tech Firms; Relaxes KYC Norms for Overseas Investors
- NPCI Launches its 4th Wholly-Subsidiary 'NTSL'; Names Vishal Kanvaty as CEO
- Scientists Identifies New Catfish Species 'Exostoma nasibarbatum' in Manipur
- Former Australian F1 World Champion Alan Jones Passed Away At 80
- Former SPG Commando and Four-Time HP's MLA 'Nand Lal' Passed Away at 72
- International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, Including Cyberbullying 2026 – 5 November
- International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict 2026 – November 6
- Odisha Signs MoU with J-PAL South Asia to Strengthen Evidence-Based Policymaking

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

NATIONAL AFFAIRS

Union Cabinet Approves Rs. 4,371.10 Crore VISTAR Scheme to Modernise India's Statistical System

In November 2026, the Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister (**PM**) **Narendra Modi**, approved the Viksit Bharat Initiative for Statistical Transformation, Analytics & Research (**VISTAR**) Scheme, a Central Sector Scheme (**CSS**) with an outlay of **Rs. 4,371.10 crore** for **five** years from Financial Year 2026 -2027 (**FY27**) to **FY31**, aligning with the **16th** Finance Commission cycle.

- The scheme aims to establish a dynamic, agile and future-ready official statistical system capable of meeting evolving policy requirements, in line with the vision of Viksit Bharat 2047.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Approval of the VISTAR Scheme
- ✓ **Approved By:** Union Cabinet chaired by PM Narendra Modi.
- ✓ **Approval Date:** 4 November 2026
- ✓ **Outlay:** Rs. 4,371.10 crore.
- ✓ **Implementation Period:** FY27 to FY31
- ✓ **Scheme Type:** Central Sector Scheme.
- ✓ **Nodal Ministry:** MoSPI
- ✓ **Key Components:** Statistical Operations, SSS and Economic Census.
- ✓ **Major Survey Initiative:** 59 surveys during the 16th Finance Commission cycle.
- ✓ **Economic Census:** 8th Economic Census.
- ✓ **New Statistical Indices:** Headline Index of Services Production and Index of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises.

About VISTAR Scheme:

Overview: Announced on **November 4, 2026,** the scheme will be implemented by the Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (**MoSPI**) to modernise India's official statistical system through digital transformation, Artificial Intelligence (AI) and improved data governance.



Reforms: The VISTAR Scheme builds on MoSPI's recent efforts to update key statistical indicators, including the revised Consumer Price Index (**CPI**) series (2024 base year, February 2026), Gross Domestic Product (**GDP**) series (2022–23 base year), Index of Industrial Production (**IIP**) series (2022–23 base year, June 2026) and trial Index of Services Production covering 19 sub-sectors (July 2026).

New Statistical Indicators: MoSPI plans to introduce the Headline Index of Services Production to measure services-sector output and the Index of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises to track the performance of unincorporated enterprises.

Data Harmonisation: The scheme will enable standardised, interoperable and privacy-focused data sharing through machine-readable datasets, reducing duplication and fragmentation while improving programme targeting and AI-driven decision-making.

Alternative Data Sources: MoSPI will integrate mobile phone, scanner and e-commerce data with traditional surveys to reduce respondent burden, address data gaps and strengthen evidence-based policymaking.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Capacity Building: The scheme will support students and researchers through internships, research proposals from academic and research institutions, and capacity-building initiatives to strengthen statistical capabilities.

VISTAR Scheme: Three Major Components

Comprehensive Statistical Operations and Strengthening of Ecosystem:

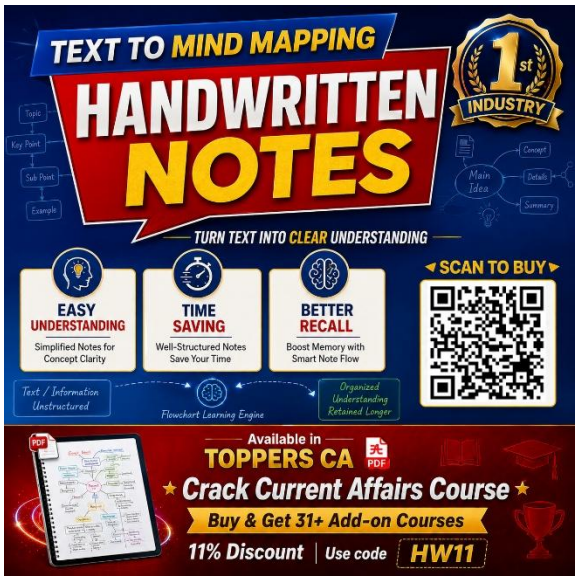
Survey Expansion: MoSPI plans to conduct **59 surveys** during the 16th Finance Commission cycle, up from **43** previously, to address sectoral data gaps and support timely, targeted policy decisions.

Digital Transformation: MoSPI will digitise statistical processes end-to-end and integrate **AI** and Machine Learning (**ML**) into regular workflows for data processing, validation, analysis, statistical research and dissemination.

Support for Statistical Strengthening (SSS 2.0)

Development: VISTAR aims to strengthen the statistical capabilities of States and Union Territories (UTs), generate high-quality, granular data, develop indigenous data-processing capabilities and improve regional economic estimates for informed local policymaking.

Data Expansion: MoSPI will provide technical support to develop district-level and million-plus city-level estimates under major statistical indicators, including the Periodic Labour Force Survey (**PLFS**), Household Consumption Expenditure Survey (**HCES**), Annual Survey of Unincorporated Sector Enterprises (**ASUSE**), **GDP** and **IIP**, along with the compilation of State-level and district-level GDP estimates and State-level IIP data.



Eighth Economic Census:

Census: MoSPI will conduct the 8th Economic Census (EC) in collaboration with State and UT Governments, which will serve as the baseline for developing the National Statistical Business Register (SBR).

Coverage: The census will collect data up to the Gram Panchayat (GP) and Ward levels, providing a detailed assessment of India's unorganised economic sector.

About Ministry of Statistics and Programme Implementation (MoSPI):

Formation: Established on October 15, 1999, through the merger of the Department of Statistics and the Department of Programme Implementation.

- The first Economic Census was conducted in 1977 by Central Statistics Organisation (**CSO**) to map non-agricultural enterprises across India.

Minister of State (MoS) (Independent Charge, IC) – Rao Inderjit Singh (Constituency: Gurugram, Haryana)

Secretary – Saurabh Garg

Cabinet Approves Rs 14,500 crore VGF Scheme for development of 92 GWh Grid-Scale Energy Storage Systems

In November 2026, the Union Cabinet, chaired by the Prime Minister (PM) Narendra Modi, approved **Rs 14,500 crore** Viability Gap Funding **(VGF) Scheme** for Development of **Grid-Scale Energy Storage Systems (ESS)** for a period of **5 years** i.e. from Financial Year 2026-27**(FY27) to FY31.**

- The newly approved scheme marks a major step towards bolstering India's power sector infrastructure, facilitating large-scale integration of Renewable Energy (RE) and ensuring reliable, affordable and 24×7 power supply.

- The Union Cabinet also approved a Capital Expenditure **(Capex) Support Scheme,** designed to promote domestic processing of **critical minerals** (including Lithium (Li) and Nickel (Ni)) with financial outlay of **Rs 2,814-crore** for a period of 5 years **(from FY27 to FY31).**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Approval of Viability Gap Funding Scheme
- ✓ **Approved by:** Union Cabinet, chaired by PM Narendra Modi
- ✓ **Purpose:** To develop grid-scale energy storage systems
- ✓ **Outlay:** Rs 14,500 crore (from FY27 to FY31)
- ✓ **Target Capacity:** 92GWh of new energy capacity
- ✓ **Estimated Investment:** Rs 97,600 crore
- ✓ **Other Key Approval:** Capex Support Scheme
  - **Total Budget:** Rs 2,814-crore (from FY27 to FY31)
  - **Purpose:** To promote critical mineral processing
  - **Target Minerals:** Li and Ni
  - **Proposed Facilities:** 4, including two of Li and two of Ni
  - **Capital Support Cap:** Rs 500 crore per Li beneficiary and Rs 900 crore per Ni beneficiary.

About VGF Scheme for Grid-Scale Energy Storage Systems:

Target Capacity: The scheme aims to develop **92 Gigawatt-hours (GWh)** of additional energy storage capacity, comprising 60 GWh of Pumped Storage Projects (PSPs), 30 GWh of Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) and 2 GWh through alternative storage technologies, with an estimated investment of **Rs 97,600 crore.**

Key Goal: It targets to support the creation of new capacities equivalent to **170%** of the present-day grid scale energy storage system capacity in the country and help meet the required Grid Scale ESS capacity of **411 GWh** by **FY32.**

Key features: Some of the other key features of the scheme include:

- **Allocation Method:** Under the VGF scheme, energy storage capacity will be allocated to eligible entities through a **tariff-based competitive bidding** process.
- **Eligible Entities:** Both public and private sector electricity Distribution Companies (DISCOMs) are eligible for VGF support for BESS and Hydro PSP projects, while projects based on alternative energy storage technologies will be implemented by public and private sector entities.
- **Domestic Content Requirement (DCR):** As per the scheme, BESS projects will be subject to a minimum Domestic Content Requirement **(DCR) of 40%.** This move is expected to promote domestic manufacturing, generate opportunities for Indian industry and complement existing supply-side incentives for battery manufacturing.



Approval of Capex Support Scheme:

Subsidy Structure: Under the newly approved scheme, the Government of India (GoI) will offer a capital subsidy of **30%** of the investment required to set up **4 critical mineral processing units** i.e. two Li processing units with minimum capacity of 30,000 tonnes (30kt) each and two Ni processing units with minimum capacity of 50 kt each.

Cobalt Recovery: The scheme also envisages recovery of cobalt as a by-product of nickel processing, supporting domestic availability of critical minerals.

Maximum Capital Threshold: The GoI has capped the maximum capital support under the scheme at Rs 500 crore per Li beneficiary and Rs 900 crore per Ni beneficiary.
Selection Process: The selection of eligible beneficiaries involves a **two-stage process** i.e. initial assessment of technical qualification; followed by financial bidding where two beneficiaries per mineral are selected based on the least-cost criterion.
Disbursement: Under the scheme, the GoI will disburse the incentives in three tranches linked to project milestones.
Key Sectors: The scheme is expected to support key sectors such as: electric mobility, BESS, electronics, defence and speciality steel, while strengthening India's local critical mineral value chain.

About Ministry of Mines (MoM):

Union Minister- Gangapuram (G.) Kishan Reddy (Constituency- Secunderabad Telangana)
Minister of State **(MoS)-** Satish Chandra Dubey (Rajya Sabha- Bihar)

Cabinet Approves Rs. 3,788.04 Crore for Continuation of Fast Track Special Courts Scheme for 5 Years till March 2031

In November 2026, the Union Cabinet, chaired by Prime Minister **(PM) Narendra Modi**, approved the continuation of the Centrally Sponsored Scheme **(CSS)** for Fast Track Special Courts **(FTSCs)**, including exclusive Protection of Children from Sexual Offences **(POCSO)** Courts**,** for **5 years** from 1 April 2026 to 31 March 2031, with a total outlay of **Rs. 3,788.04 Crore.**

Exam hints:

- ✓ **What?** Cabinet approved the continuation of FTSCs Scheme.
- ✓ **Duration:** Five years (FY 2026–27 to FY 2030–31).
- ✓ **Total Outlay:** Rs. 3,788.04 Crore; Centre – Rs. 2,353.15 Crore & State – Rs. 1,434.89 Crore.
- ✓ **Target:** 850 FTSCs, including exclusive POCSO Courts.
- ✓ **Implementing Agency:** Department of Justice, MoL&J.
- ✓ **Beneficiaries:** Women and child victims of rape and POCSO offences
- ✓ **Other Approval:** Two-year additional engagement period for the remaining 75% of Agniveers
- ✓ **Regular Recruitment:** 25% of Agniveers will continue to receive regular employment in the Defence Forces based on merit.

Background:

Launch: The scheme was launched on 2 October **2019** following the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act, 2018, and the Supreme Court's directions dated 25 July 2019, which called for exclusive Special Courts in districts with more than 100 pending cases under the POCSO Act, 2012.
Administrative Ministry: Implemented by the Department of Justice (DoJ) under the Ministry of Law and Justice (MoL&J).
Coverage: The scheme operates across 29 States/Union Territories (UT) with 779 functional FTSCs, including 399 exclusive POCSO Courts, and has disposed of **4,02,457 cases** since its launch.

Highlights of the Fast Track Special Courts Scheme:

Objectives: The scheme aims to ensure time-bound trials, reduce the pendency of rape and POCSO cases, and improve access to justice for women and children
Expansion: The number of functional Fast Track Special Courts (FTSCs) will increase from 779 to 850, based on case pendency across States and UTs.
Financial Allocation: The Government of India will contribute **Rs. 2,353.15 Crore**, funded through the **Nirbhaya Fund**, while the State Governments and UTs will contribute **Rs. 1,434.89 Crore** under the approved CSS funding pattern.
Staffing: Each FTSC will have one dedicated Judicial Officer, one Special Public Prosecutor and six support staff to expedite the disposal of pending cases.

 Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Victim Support: The scheme promotes Vulnerable Witness Deposition Centres (VWDCs) and child-friendly court spaces to provide a victim-centric environment for recording testimonies.
Monitoring: DoJ, MoL&J will monitor implementation through the FTSC Dashboard, periodic progress reports, expenditure statements and consultations with High Courts and State Governments.

Cabinet Approves Two-Year Extension for Agniveers, Enabling Regular Service

The Union Cabinet approved an additional **two-year engagement** period for the remaining **75% of Agniveers** after their initial four-year service under the Agnipath Scheme, providing an opportunity for regular enrolment after six years, subject to willingness and prescribed selection criteria, while retaining the existing provision for **25% merit-based regular** enrolment after four years.

- **Enhanced Benefits:** The second engagement period will provide higher remuneration, an enhanced **Seva Nidhi package** and seniority benefits to Agniveers.

Performance Assessment: The Armed Forces' four-year assessment reported positive feedback on Agniveers' skills, motivation, morale, physical fitness, discipline and technological capabilities.
Organisational Efficiency: The revised framework, based on the Armed Forces' detailed evaluation and recommendations, aims to align Agniveers' career aspirations with organisational requirements and operational efficiency while ensuring the continuation of the Agnipath Scheme..

About Ministry of Law and Justice (MoL&J):

Minister of State (MoS) (Independent Charge) – Arjun Ram Meghwal (Constituency – Bikaner, Rajasthan)

1st International Maize Conference 2026 Held in Hyderabad to Strengthen Maize Productivity and Sustainability

The **1st International Maize Conference** was held from **2–4 November 2026** at the JD Convention Centre, **Hyderabad, Telangana,** bringing together national and international experts to advance maize research, productivity, farmer-centric innovation and sustainable value-chain development.

- The conference was organised around the theme "Maize Revolution for Food, Feed, Fodder, Fuel and Sustainability in the Changing World(M4FS)".

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** 1st International Maize Conference 2026.
- ✓ **Where?** Hyderabad, Telangana
- ✓ **Theme?** "Maize Revolution for Food, Feed, Fodder, Fuel and Sustainability in the Changing World"
- ✓ **Organisers:** MTAI, PJTAU, ICAR, TAAS, CIMMYT, ICAR-IIMR
- ✓ **Production Target:** Increase India's maize production from over 55 million tonnes to 75 million tonnes over the next decade.
- ✓ **5F Framework:** Food, Feed, Fodder, Fuel and Farmers.

About 1st International Maize Conference 2026:

Organisers: The three-day conference was jointly organised by the Maize Technologists Association of India (MTAI), Professor Jayashankar Telangana Agricultural University (PJTAU), Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR), Trust for Advancement of Agricultural Sciences (TAAS), International Maize and Wheat Improvement Center (CIMMYT) and ICAR-Indian Institute of Maize Research (ICAR-IIMR).
Conference: Bringing together national and international scientists, policymakers, agricultural institutions, universities, and industry stakeholders to advance maize research, enhance productivity, promote farmer-centric innovation, and support sustainable value-chain development.
Focus: Key areas included high-yielding varieties and hybrids, improved nutritional quality, resistance to biotic and abiotic stresses, efficient resource utilisation, mechanisation, capacity development, robust seed systems and maize's contribution to food, feed, fodder and energy security.
Production: India's maize production has reached approximately **55 million tonnes (MT)**, with substantial productivity gains over the past decade, alongside a target of **75 MT over the next decade** through a

further 1.5-fold increase in productivity, technological innovation, improved crop management and better agronomic practices.

Framework: The traditional **4F framework** (Food, Feed, Fodder and Fuel) was expanded to **5F by adding Farmers**, placing them at the centre of agricultural research to improve farm profitability, livelihoods and bridge crop-management-related yield gaps.

Cultivation: Expand maize cultivation across Kharif, Rabi and Spring seasons without affecting oilseeds and pulses, ensuring affordable access to quality seeds, particularly public-sector hybrids.

Awards: ICAR and **MTAI** conferred awards on scientists for outstanding contributions to germplasm conservation, climate-resilient breeding and agronomic innovations, alongside the release of scientific publications during the conference.

About Maize:

India: India ranks fourth globally in total area under maize cultivation and is among the leading maize-producing countries, with Madhya Pradesh, Karnataka, Maharashtra, Bihar, Rajasthan, Uttar Pradesh and Telangana as major producing states.

Global: The United States of America **(USA),** China, Brazil, Argentina, the European Union (EU) and India are among the leading maize producers for 2025–26.

Research: Maize is an important crop for food, nutritional and energy security, with **329 maize hybrids** developed over the previous five years and the All India Coordinated Research Project on Maize (AICRP on Maize) identified for further strengthening.

Ethanol: Maize serves as an important feedstock for ethanol production, supporting India's bioenergy development and energy security through research-industry collaboration and bio-refineries, contributing to the country's 20% ethanol blending target.

About Maize Technologists Association of India (MTAI):

President – Dr. H.S. Jat

Headquarters – New Delhi, Delhi

Established – 2011

IndiaAI Mission Releases Indigenous AI Foundation Models EKA-1, Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B

In November 2026, IndiaAI Mission under Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) released **three** indigenous Artificial Intelligence (**AI**) foundation models, **EKA-1, Dhīr 2B** and **Dhīr 5B**, developed by **Soket Labs Technology** and **Research Private Limited** and **ZenteiQ AiTech Innovations** under the IndiaAI Innovation Centre (Foundation Models) pillar of the IndiaAI Mission.

- The models were unveiled in the presence of **S. Krishnan**, Secretary, MeitY in New Delhi, Delhi

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Release of three indigenous AI foundation models.
- ✓ **Released Under:** IndiaAI Mission, MeitY
- ✓ **Models:** EKA-1, Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B.
- ✓ **Developers:** Soket Labs Technology and Research Private Limited and ZenteiQ AiTech Innovations.
- ✓ **EKA-1 Parameters:** 26.3 billion.
- ✓ **EKA-1 Training Data:** Approximately 7.5 trillion tokens.
- ✓ **Language Support:** EKA-1 supports all 22 Scheduled Indian Languages alongside English.
- ✓ **Dhīr Models:** Support English and 10 Indian languages.
- ✓ **Key Applications:** Cybersecurity, banking, defence, government, industrial and educational sectors.

About Indigenous AI Foundation Models:

Development: The models were developed with support from subsidised national AI computing infrastructure, ancillary research funding under the IndiaAI Mission, and access to **AIKosh**, which makes AI resources accessible to researchers, students, innovators and the public.

EKA-1: An open, sparse hybrid language model with 26.3 billion parameters, trained on 7.5 trillion tokens, supporting all 22 Scheduled Indian Languages and English, with advanced mathematics, coding, reasoning and agentic capabilities.
Dhīr 2B and Dhīr 5B: Compact, open-source AI models supporting English and 10 Indian languages, enabling secure, offline and on-premise deployment for document-based automation and knowledge retrieval across defence, government, industry and education.
Deployment: The models support deployment across Graphics Processing Units (GPUs), Tensor Processing Units (TPUs) and mobile devices, enabling offline, on-device AI processing without cloud connectivity while ensuring greater data privacy and security.

TRAI Launches 'Network Anubhav' Platform to Monitor Network Performance

On 4 November 2026, the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India **(TRAI)**, Ministry of Communications, launched the **'Network Anubhav Platform'**, a geospatial dashboard integrating user test data with TRAI's Independent Drive Test **(IDT)** data and providing a web interface for Do Not Disturb **(DND)** services.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Network Anubhav Platform launched
- ✓ **Launched by:** TRAI
- ✓ **Type:** Geospatial and analytical dashboard
- ✓ **Objective:** Monitor network performance and improve telecom service quality
- ✓ **Data Sources:** MySpeed, MyCall and Independent Drive Tests.

About Network Anubhav Platform:

Objective: To improve transparency in telecom network performance and enable consumers, Telecom Service Providers (TSPs) and TRAI to assess service quality using location-specific network data.
Integration: The platform integrates consumer-generated data from TRAI's **MySpeed** and **MyCall** applications(apps), along with Independent Drive Test (IDT) results, to assess network performance.
Key Features: The platform offers an interactive geospatial dashboard to compare network coverage, internet speeds and call quality across locations and operators, with filtering and report-download options.

- It also supports the MySpeed Software Development Kit (SDK), enabling third-party applications to integrate internet speed-testing features.

About TRAI: Established on 20 February 1997 under the TRAI Act, 1997, TRAI is a statutory regulatory body headquartered in New Delhi, Delhi. Its Chairman is Anil Kumar Lahoti.

IICA Signs MoU with IAMC to Strengthen India's Alternative Dispute Resolution Ecosystem

On 4 November 2026, the Indian Institute of Corporate Affairs **(IICA**) signed a Memorandum of Understanding **(MoU)** with the International Arbitration and Mediation Centre **(IAMC)**, Hyderabad, to to strengthen India's Alternative Dispute Resolution **(ADR) ecosystem** and improve the Ease of Doing Business **(EoDB).**

- The MoU was signed by Col. Amandeep Singh Puri, Chief Administrative Officer, IICA, and AJ Jawad, Chief Executive Officer (CEO) & Registrar, IAMC in the presence of Gyaneshwar Kumar Singh, Director-General & CEO, IICA.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** MoU signed
- ✓ **Between:** IICA and IAMC, Hyderabad
- ✓ **Signatories:** Col. Amandeep Singh Puri (IICA) and AJ Jawad (IAMC)
- ✓ **Purpose:** To strengthen India's Alternative Dispute Resolution (ADR) ecosystem
- ✓ **Key Focus:** Capacity building, MSME mediation and policy research.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Highlights of the MoU:

Specialised Capacity Building: Create a specialised pool of arbitrators, mediators and dispute resolution professionals through customised short-term and long-term courses, workshops, seminars and skill development programmes.

MSME Sector Mediation: Strengthen mediation in the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises **(MSME)** sector, recognising its linkages with economic growth, Gross Domestic Product (GDP) and exports.

Research & Institutional Collaboration: Leverage the institutional expertise and resources of IICA and IAMC to develop structured programmes, joint initiatives and policy-oriented research, promoting professional excellence, best practices and innovation in India's ADR ecosystem towards **Viksit Bharat@2047.**

IICA: Established in 2008, IICA is an institution under the Ministry of Corporate Affairs (MCA), headquartered in Gurugram, Haryana. Its Director-General (DG) and CEO is Gyaneshwar Kumar Singh.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

Bahamas Joins International Solar Alliance as 116th Member Country

On 4 November 2026, the **Commonwealth of the Bahamas** joined the International Solar Alliance **(ISA)** as its **116th member**, following the submission of its Instrument of Accession to the ISA Framework Agreement during the **9th Session** of the ISA Assembly in New Delhi, Delhi.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** The Bahamas joined the International Solar Alliance (ISA)
- ✓ **Member:** 116th member
- ✓ **Which Session?** 9th Session of ISA Assembly
- ✓ **Where?** New Delhi, India.
- ✓ **Representative:** Peter Nicholas Symonette Jr., High Commissioner of the Bahamas.
- ✓ **Received by:** P.S. Gangadhar, Joint Secretary, Economic Diplomacy and Head of Depository.

Highlights of Bahamas Joining ISA:

Formal Accession: The Instrument of Accession was formally handed over by Peter Nicholas Symonette Jr., High Commissioner of the Bahamas, to P.S. Gangadhar, Joint Secretary, Economic Diplomacy and Head of Depository, to strengthen the Bahamas' participation in international solar energy cooperation.

Solar Cooperation: ISA promotes **solar energy deployment** through knowledge-sharing, technical assistance, collaborative initiatives and investment facilitation, particularly in Least Developed Countries **(LDCs)** and Small Island Developing States **(SIDS)**.

Future Collaboration: Membership enables the Bahamas to participate in ISA programmes, access technical expertise and explore collaborative funding frameworks.

About the International Solar Alliance (ISA):

Establishment: India and France jointly launched the ISA during the **21st Conference** of the Parties (COP21) to the United Nations **(UN)** Framework Convention on Climate Change (UNFCCC) in Paris in 2015. The ISA is headquartered in Gurugram, Haryana, India.

Objectives: The ISA aims to expand affordable clean energy access, strengthen energy security by reducing fossil fuel imports and accelerate the global energy transition through solar deployment and prioritise support for LDCs and SIDS.

Towards 1000 Strategy: Aims by 2030 to mobilise USD 1 trillion in solar investments, provide clean-energy access to 1 billion people, install 1,000 Gigawatt (GW) of solar capacity and mitigate 1 billion tonnes of CO_2 (Carbon-di-oxide) emissions annually.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

About Bahamas:

Prime Minister **(PM) –** Philip Davis.
Official Name – Commonwealth of The Bahamas.
Capital – Nassau
Currency – Bahamian Dollar (BSD).

BANKING & FINANCE

RBI Constitutes TCCFM to Focus on Financial markets, Eases Reporting Requirement for Small Service Exporters and Importers

In November 2026, the Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) constituted a Technical Consultative Committee for Financial Markets (**TCCFM**) to strengthen engagement with market participants on policy and operational issues related to money markets, government securities, foreign exchange and derivatives.

- The RBI also amended the **Foreign Exchange Management (Export and Import of Goods and Services) Regulations, 2026,** easing reporting requirements for small-value service exports and imports, effective retrospectively from 1 October 2026.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** RBI Constituted TCCFM
- ✓ **Focus:** Money Markets, G-Secs, Forex, Derivative markets
- ✓ **Chairperson**: Deputy Governor Rohit Jain
- ✓ **Other Members:** Ananth Narayan, Shamsher Singh, Neeraj Gambhir, Shailendra Jhingan, Aditya Bagree, Nand Kishore, Ridham Desai
- ✓ **Other Key Decision:** RBI eases reporting requirement for small service exporters and importers
  - **EDF Exemption:** Individual exporters, Non-individual for service export receipts up to Rs 10 lakhs
  - **IDPMS:** Details uploaded within 5 working days. Not applicable to: Resident Individual; Invoice less than Rs 10 lakhs.

About Technical Consultative Committee for Financial Markets (TCCFM):

Objective: The committee will serve as a forum for engagement with market participants and stakeholders by the RBI to examine key policy and operational issues affecting India's financial markets.
Chairman: The committee will be headed by **Rohit Jain,** Deputy Governor (**DG**), in charge of the Financial Markets Regulation Department (**FMRD**) of the RBI.
Other Members: The committee will comprise the following external members:

- **Ananth Narayan** – Former Whole Time Member, SEBI, and Professor of Practice, IIT (Indian Institute of Technology) Bombay
- **Shamsher Singh** – Chairman, Fixed Income Money Market and Derivatives Association of India (**FIMMDA**) and Deputy Managing Director, State Bank of India
- **Neeraj Gambhir** – Executive Director, Axis Bank
- **Shailendra Jhingan –** Head, Treasury and Economic Research, ICICI Bank
- **Aditya Bagree** – Managing Director (**MD**), Head (Markets), Citibank India
- **Nand Kishore** – MD, Clearing Corporation of India Limited (**CCIL**) and
- **Ridham Desai** – MD, Morgan Stanley India

Terms of Reference (ToR): The committee will review the efficiency, liquidity and resilience of money, government securities and foreign exchange markets, recommend measures for market development, assess trading, clearing, settlement and reporting systems, and examine financial innovations, emerging risks and specific market-related issues referred by the RBI.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Meeting Frequency: The meeting will be conducted at least once **every quarter,** providing a regular channel for interaction between the RBI and external stakeholders.

RBI Eased Reporting Requirements:

Background: The RBI introduced new foreign exchange reporting regulations for export and import of goods and services effective from **1 October 2026**.

- Individual service exporters, including freelancers and consultants, as well as Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises (**MSMEs**), have reportedly faced difficulties in receiving payments from overseas clients.
- The issue arises from banks insisting that exporters submit a complex five-page Export Declaration Form (**EDF**) to process foreign payments, despite the RBI explicitly exempting individual service exporters from this requirement.

Individuals: Resident individuals exporting services will be deemed to have submitted the EDF once they provide the required payment information to their authorised dealer (**AD**) bank for crediting the inward remittance.

Non-Individuals: Non-individual exporters will receive similar treatment for service export receipts of up to **Rs 10 lakhs**.

- For larger receipts, existing EDF requirements will continue to apply.

IDPMS: Under the amended regulations, AD banks must enter details of service imports in the Import Data Processing and Monitoring System (**IDPMS**) within **five working days** of receiving information, subject to the following conditions:

- The importer is not a resident individual (**RI**)
- The invoice or contract value exceeds Rs 10 lakhs.

Key Terms:

Import Data Processing and Monitoring System (**IDPMS**): It is a centralized digital platform launched by the Reserve Bank of India (**RBI**) and Indian Customs to track, monitor, and reconcile import transactions and foreign exchange payments.

Export Declaration Form (EDF): It is a mandatory foreign exchange declaration under India's Foreign Exchange Management Act (FEMA), 1999 that records the full export value of goods, software, or services leaving India.

About the Reserve Bank of India (RBI):

Governor – Sanjay Malhotra
Headquarters – Mumbai, Maharashtra
Established – 1st April, 1935

SEBI Sets Up Panel to Ease Market Access for Startups, Deep-tech Firms; Relaxes KYC Norms for Overseas Investors

In November 2026, the Securities and Exchange Board of India **(SEBI)** formed an **18-**member Working Group **(WG)** to review the regulatory framework governing the Innovators Growth Platform **(IGP)** under SEBI (Issue of Capital and Disclosure Requirements) Regulations, 2018 (ICDR Regulations).

- The formation of new WG is aimed at enhancing access to capital markets for start-ups and deep-tech companies.
- SEBI also relaxed Know Your Client **(KYC) norms** for Non-Resident Indians (NRIs), Overseas Citizens of India (OCIs) and foreign nationals, allowing eligible investors to complete digital onboarding from abroad without visiting India, effective **3 December 2026.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Constitution of 18-member WG to review framework related to IGP
- ✓ **Constituted by:** SEBI

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

- ✓ **Aim:** To enhance market access for start-ups and deep-tech firms
- ✓ **Co-chairpersons:** Srini Srinivasan, chairman of IVCA; and Prashanth Prakash, partner at Accel Partners
- ✓ **Regulatory Framework**: SEBI ICDR Regulations, 2018
- ✓ **Other Key Decision**: Relaxation of KYC norms for overseas investors
  - **Beneficiaries:** NRIs, OCIs and foreign nationals
  - **KYC Effective Date**: 3 December 2026
  - **Key Feature:** Digital onboarding from FATF-compliant countries
  - **KYC Upload Timeline:** Within 3 working days.

Key Details of WG:

Chairpersons: Srini Srinivasan, chairman of the Indian Venture and Alternate Capital Association(IVCA); along with **Prashanth Prakash,** partner at Accel Partners, will co-chair the newly formed panel.

Other Key Members: Other than chairpersons, the group comprises:

- **Representatives from key industries:** PM Murali, President of Association of Biotechnology led Enterprises; MD Rangnath, chairman of Catamaran Venture; Umakant Soni, co-founder of Bharat.1AI; Kedar Upadhye, Chief Financial Officer (CFO) of Biocon; among others.
- **Representatives from Key Government and Private Bodies:** the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade (DPIIT) under the Ministry of Commerce and Industry (MoCI); the Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI) ; the Institute of Company Secretaries of India; Confederation of Indian Industry (CII); National Stock Exchange (NSE), Bombay Stock Exchange (BSE) and SEBI.

Terms of Reference (ToR): As per the SEBI's direction, the newly formed group will review the existing eligibility and listing requirements and examine their suitability for research-stage, pre-revenue, Intellectual Property (IP)-led, deep-tech companies.

- It will also assess the eligibility, participation and investment requirements applicable to IGP investors.
- In addition, it will evaluate the framework governing public issues and Offers for Sale (OFS), including pricing, allocation and minimum subscription requirements for companies seeking to list on the platform.

SEBI Simplifies KYC Norms for Foreign Investors:

Digital Onboarding Process: Also, SEBI has allowed the market intermediaries to accept KYC information and documents through digital channels from eligible clients.

- Further, eligible investors can submit the specimen signatures digitally, subject to verification during Video-based In-Person Verification (VIPV).

Required Documents: As per the new framework, eligible overseas investors are required to submit copies of their passports and, where applicable, OCI cards.

Record Portability: Under the new framework, all KYC records will be a portable i.e. allowing the intermediaries to rely on KYC undertaken by another SEBI-registered intermediary or entity regulated by another financial sector regulator, based on records obtained from a KYC Regulating Agencies (KRA) or the Central KYC Records Registry (CKYCRR). This unique feature reduces the duplication of documentation and verification.

- Also, intermediaries are 1st required to seek investor's Permanent Account Number (PAN) and Central KYC ID, if available, and only request additional details if records are incomplete.

Timeline: SEBI has directed the intermediaries to upload completed KYC records to KRAs within **3 working days.**

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

CKYC Number: The Central Know Your Customer (CKYC) Identification Number is a unique 14-digit identifier generated by the CKYCRR after registration of a customer's KYC details. It enables financial institutions to retrieve existing KYC records, reducing repeated documentation.

About Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI):

SEBI is the apex regulatory body for securities and commodity market in India. It was initially established as a non-statutory body in April 1988. Later, SEBI was accorded the status of **statutory body** through SEBI Act, 1992 on **January 30, 1992.**

Chairman- Tuhin Kanta Pandey

Headquarters- Mumbai, Maharashtra

NPCI Launches its 4th Wholly-Subsidiary 'NTSL'; Names Vishal Kanvaty as CEO

In November 2026, the National Payments Corporation of India **(NPCI),** launched NPCI Tech Solutions Limited **(NTSL),** a new technology and innovation arm of NPCI group.

- Also, NTSL has become the **4th** wholly-owned subsidiary of NPCI, after NPCI International Payments Limited (NIPL); NPCI Bharat BillPay Limited (NBBL); and NPCI Bharat Interface for Money (BHIM) Services Limited (NBSL).

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** NPCI Launches its 4th wholly-owned Subsidiary
- ✓ **Name of New Subsidiary:** NTSL
- ✓ **MD & CEO:** Vishal Kanvaty
- ✓ **Subsidiary Focused on:** AI, Blockchain, Digital Financial Infrastructure, and GCC
- ✓ **Other 3 NPCI's Subsidiaries:** NIPL, NBBL and NBSL

About NPCI Tech Solutions Limited (NTSL):

MD & CEO: Also, **Vishal Kanvaty**, Chief Technology Officer (CTO) of NPCI, has been named as the Managing Director (MD) and Chief Executive Officer (CEO) of the newly formed tech arm.

Focus Areas: NTSL will focus on areas like: Artificial Intelligence (AI), blockchain, digital financial infrastructure and Global Capability Centre (GCC) services.

Key Offerings: The company will offer key technology services for electronic-Know Your Customer (e-KYC) Setu, the Unified Ticketing Platform (UTP) and other Digital Public Infrastructure (DPI).

About NPCI: Established in 2008 as a not-for-profit company by the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) and Indian Banks' Association (IBA), NPCI is headquartered in Mumbai, Maharashtra, with Dilip Asbe serving as its Managing Director and Chief Executive Officer (MD & CEO).

ENVIRONMENT

Scientists Identifies New Catfish Species 'Exostoma nasibarbatum' in Manipur

In November 2026, researchers from Dhanamanjuri University, Imphal, Manipur, identified a new species of freshwater catfish named '**Exostoma nasibarbatum'** in the Bupal stream of Chandel district, **Manipur,** near the India–Myanmar border.

- The key findings of the new catfish species has been published in the **Journal of Natural History.**

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Identification of new catfish species
- ✓ **Identified by:** Group of Scientists from Manipur
- ✓ **New Species Name:** Exostoma nasibarbatum
- ✓ **Discovery Location:** Bupal stream of Dujang riverChandel district of Manipur
- ✓ **Taxonomy:** Sisoridae family

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

- ✓ **Key Feature:** Unusually long nasal barbel extending beyond the eye
- ✓ **Habitat:** Fast-flowing, rocky freshwater streams.

About Exostoma nasibarbatum:

Genus Family: The newly identified catfish species belongs to the **Sisoridae family.**

Etymology: The word "nasibarbatum" is inspired from latin words nasus (nose) and barba (beard), which refers to the species elongated nasal barbels.

Habitat: Exostoma is found to live near the cold freshwater with temperature ranging between 12 degree Celsius (℃) and 14℃, where water rushes over rocks and boulders.

Appearance: The catfish species has a flattened head and body which helps in resisting fast-flowing mountain waters over rocky beds; enlarged fins with adhesive ridges and elongated whisker-like structure near its nostril.

Species Diversity: The genus Exostoma comprises 23 recognised species across the Indian subcontinent and Southeast Asia, including seven species recorded in the Chindwin–Irrawaddy drainage.

OBITUARY

Former Australian F1 World Champion Alan Jones Passed Away At 80

In November 2026, former Australian Formula One (**F1**) World Champion **Alan Stanley Jones,** who won the **1980 F1 World Drivers'** Championship with Williams Racing, passed away at the age of 80 in Australia.

- He became the **second Australian** to win the F1 World Championship, after **Sir Jack Brabham,** and was the first driver to secure a Drivers' Championship title for Williams Racing.

Exam Hints

- ✓ **What?** Former Australian F1 World Champion Passed Away
- ✓ **Who?** Alan Jones
- ✓ **Major Achievement:** 1980 Formula One Drivers' World Championship
- ✓ **Career:** 116 F1 race starts and 12 Grand Prix victories
- ✓ **First F1 Victory:** 1977 Austrian Grand Prix, driving for Shadow
- ✓ **F1 Debut:** 1975 Spanish Grand Prix
- ✓ **Last F1 Victory:** 1981 Las Vegas Grand Prix
- ✓ **Legacy:** Last Australian F1 World Champion
- ✓ **Honour:** Member of the Order of the British Empire (MBE), 1980

About Alan Jones:

Early Life: Born on November 2, 1946, in Melbourne, Australia, he was the son of Australian racing driver Stan Jones, winner of the 1959 Australian Grand Prix.

F1 Career: He made his F1 debut with Hesketh at the 1975 Spanish Grand Prix (GP), claimed his maiden victory with Shadow at the 1977 Austrian GP and secured his final win at the 1981 Las Vegas GP.

- He secured 12 GP victories and 116 F1 race starts.

Career Highlights: He joined Williams in 1978 and secured five Grand Prix victories during the 1980 season, helping the team win its first Drivers' and Constructors' Championships

Awards and Recognition: He was appointed a Member of the Order of the British Empire (MBE) in 1980 for services to motor racing and was inducted into the Sport Australia Hall of Fame in 1985.

Former SPG Commando and Four-Time HP's MLA 'Nand Lal' Passed Away at 72

On 3 November 2026, former Special Protection Group **(SPG) commando** and four-time Member of the Legislative Assembly (MLA) from Rampur, Himachal Pradesh (HP) **Nand Lal**, associated with the Indian

National Congress (INC), **passed away** at the age of **72** in Shimla, HP. He was born on 16 April 1954 in Devthi village, Shimla district, HP.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Former SPG Cammondo and four Time HP MLA Passed away
- ✓ **Who?** Nand Lal
- ✓ **Age:** 72 years.
- ✓ **Political Party:** Indian National Congress.
- ✓ **Nickname:** Known as "Sonia's Sentinel"
- ✓ **SPG Tenure:** 1985 to 1997.

About Nand Lal:

Career: Began his career with the Indo-Tibetan Border Police (ITBP) in 1980 and joined the Special Protection Group (SPG) in 1985, serving until 1997. He was part of the security detail of Sonia Gandhi, earning the nickname **"Sonia's Sentinel".**

Political Entry: He represented the Rampur Assembly constituency for four consecutive terms after winning the 2007, 2012, 2017 and 2022 Assembly elections on a Congress ticket.

Positions: Served as Chief Parliamentary Secretary from 2013 to 2017 and chaired the Seventh HP State Finance Commission from 2024 until his demise. He also served on various Assembly committees.

Recognition: Received commendation certificates from former Prime Ministers (PM) Rajiv Gandhi and Chandra Shekhar for his security services and was awarded the President's Police Medal for Meritorious Service (2001) and the President's Police Medal for Distinguished Service year.

IMPORTANT DAYS

International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, Including Cyberbullying 2026 – 5 November

The United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization **(UNESCO)** observes the International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, including Cyberbullying, globally every year on the **first Thursday of November.**

- In **2026**, the Day was observed on **5 November**, marking the beginning of the second five-year cycle of the observance.

Theme:

2026 Theme: "Every learner safe and well: From promise to practice."

Focus: The theme promotes a whole-school approach to violence prevention, mental health, inclusion, teacher support and digital safety.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, including Cyberbullying 2026
- ✓ **When?** First Thursday of November (5th November 2026)
- ✓ **2026 Theme:** Every learner safe and well: From promise to practice.
- ✓ **First Observed:** 5 November 2020
- ✓ **Key Focus:** School safety, cyberbullying prevention, and learners' mental health and well-being.

Background:

Establishment: The International Day against Violence and Bullying at School, including Cyberbullying, was proclaimed by the UNESCO General Conference through Resolution 40 C/Resolution 19, adopted on 25 November 2019, during its 40th session in Paris, France.

First Observance: The International Day was first observed on 5 November 2020.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

2026 Event Highlights:

UNESCO Member State Dialogue: UNESCO will convene a briefing and policy dialogue with Member States at its Headquarters in **Paris, France**, co-sponsored by the Permanent Delegations of **Ireland and Mexico**, to explore actions for preventing school violence and bullying and promoting safe, inclusive learning environments.

Key Areas of Discussion: Focused on translating policies into **classroom-level action**, establishing trusted reporting and referral systems, and strengthening teacher capacity, monitoring and accountability to prevent school violence and bullying.

Upcoming Global Conference: The **Second Global Ministerial Conference** on Ending Violence Against Children is scheduled for **18–19 November 2026** in **Manila, Philippines**, to build on the commitments made at the 2024 Bogotá Ministerial Conference and accelerate action on proven prevention measures, including safe and enabling schools.

Key Findings:

- **Cyberbullying:** Affects **1 in 10 learners** globally, with prevalence across 44 countries rising from 12% (2018) to 15% (2022).
- **Mental Health:** UNESCO, United Nations Children's Fund (UNICEF) and World Health Organization (WHO) (2026) report that **1 in 7 adolescents** globally experiences a mental health condition.
- **Action Areas:** Governance, safeguarding, workforce support and curriculum.

UNESCO Publications: Released Connected and Safe, a technical brief on online violence in education, and Teaching with Care, a practical guide for promoting mental health and well-being in schools.

India's Initiatives to Address Cyberbullying:

UNESCO–NCERT Training (2026): UNESCO, in collaboration with Central Institute of Educational Technology **(CIET),** National Council of Educational Research and Training **(NCERT)**, conducted a national training programme in June 2026 to strengthen educators' capacity to address online violence against children.

Legal Framework: Cyber offences are covered under the Information Technology (IT) Act, 2000, and IT Rules, 2021; complaints can be reported through the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (cybercrime.gov.in).

International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict 2026 – November 6

The United Nations (UN) observes the **International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict** annually on **6 November** to highlight the environmental consequences of armed conflicts and promote the protection of natural resources and ecosystems.

- 6 November 2026 marks the **25th** annual observance of the International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict 2026
- ✓ **When?** 6 November, 2026
- ✓ **Observed by:** UN
- ✓ **2026 Edition:** 25th annual observance
- ✓ **First Observance:** 6 November 2002
- ✓ **Focus:** Protecting the environment from the impacts of war and armed conflicts.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Background:

Establishment: The United Nations General Assembly **(UNGA)** adopted Resolution A/RES/56/4 on 5 November **2001,** declaring 6 November every year as the International Day for Preventing the Exploitation of the Environment in War and Armed Conflict.

First Observance: The first observance was held on **6 November 2002.**

Resolution : On 27 May 2016, the United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA) adopted Resolution UNEP/EA.2/Res.15 – Protection of the Environment in Areas Affected by Armed Conflict.

- The resolution recognised the role of healthy ecosystems and sustainably managed natural resources in reducing the risk of armed conflicts and reaffirmed its strong commitment to the full implementation of the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) under the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development.

Environmental Impact:

Natural Resource Exploitation: According to the United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP), at least **40%** of intrastate conflicts over the last 60 years have been linked to natural-resource exploitation. Such conflicts also have twice the risk of relapse within the first five years.

UNEP Report (2025): UNEP released its second assessment of environmental damage in **Gaza**, highlighting damage to water, soil and coastal ecosystems and recommending measures for environmental recovery and reconstruction.

Partnerships:

EU–UN Collaboration on Natural Resource Conflicts: The European Union (EU) partners with **Six UN** entities:

- United Nations Environment Programme **(UNEP)**, United Nations Development Programme **(UNDP)**, United Nations Human Settlements Programme **(UN-Habitat)**, Peacebuilding Support Office **(PBSO)**, Department of Political Affairs **(DPA)** and Department of Economic and Social Affairs **(DESA)** to help countries prevent and resolve conflicts over natural resources through peacebuilding initiatives.

Post-Conflict Peacebuilding Research: Initiated by the Environmental Law Institute **(ELI)**, UNEP and the Universities of Tokyo and McGill to document best practices in natural-resource management during post-conflict recovery.

Women and Natural Resources Partnership: UNEP, UN Women, UNDP and PBSO collaborate to promote women's empowerment, gender equality and sustainable resource management in conflict-affected areas. The partnership released its first joint policy report in 2013.

About United Nations Environment Programme (UNEP):

Executive Director (ED)- Inger Andersen

Headquarters – Nairobi, Kenya

Established – 1972

STATE NEWS

Odisha Signs MoU with J-PAL South Asia to Strengthen Evidence-Based Policymaking

In November 2026, the **Government of Odisha** signed a **3year** Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) with the Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab **(J-PAL) South Asia** to strengthen evidence-based policymaking, improve governance and support the state's development goals.

- The partnership will support **Odisha Vision 2036 and 2047**, which aims to transform the state into Samruddha Odisha by 2036 and Viksit Odisha by 2047.

Exam Hints:

- ✓ **What?** Odisha signed an MoU with J-PAL South Asia.
- ✓ **Duration:** 3 years.
- ✓ **Purpose:** Strengthen evidence-based policymaking.
- ✓ **Vision:** Samruddha Odisha by 2036 and Viksit Odisha by 2047.
- ✓ **Key Initiative:** Barnali gender-equity curriculum in around 23,000 government schools.

Highlights of Odisha–J-PAL South Asia Partnership:

Signatories: The MoU was formally signed by **Rashmi Kabi**, Financial Adviser-cum-Additional Secretary, Planning & Convergence Department, Government of Odisha, and **Shobhini Mukerji**, Executive Director (ED), J-PAL South Asia.

Research Areas: J-PAL South Asia will work with government departments to identify policy challenges, generate research evidence and translate findings into actionable recommendations for evidence-based policymaking and interventions.

Monitoring Mechanism: A Chief Secretary-led Steering Committee will oversee the partnership, review projects every six months and coordinate implementation through designated nodal officers in consultation with relevant departments.

Barnali Initiative: J-PAL South Asia supports the implementation of Barnali, a gender-equity curriculum taught in around 23,000 government schools, in partnership with the School & Mass Education Department and Breakthrough Trust.

About J-PAL: Established in 2003, headquartered at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT), Cambridge, United States of America (USA), and led globally by Executive Director Iqbal Dhaliwal; J-PAL South Asia is based at Institute for Financial Management and Research (IFMR), Chennai, Tamil Nadu (TN).



Disclaimer

Aim

We Try to Cover 15+ Current Affairs Questions in Upcoming Bank Exams from Handwritten Notes

Ultimate Tool for Beginners

HandWritten Notes, meticulously designed to guide beginners in capturing important points from news and to enlighten the note-taking process

Mind Mapping

It helps to understand the news easily and We map the news in a way that boosts your memory power, ensuring you remember important information.

Note: In future, Homework Notes can be read only in our mobile App/Website and will no longer be available for download.

Less Important NEWS

- FIRST TRAINING SQUADRON OF THE INDIAN NAVY DEPARTS COLOMBO, SRI LANKA
- UPI Enabled for Online Bookings at Burj Khalifa, Resorts World Sentosa
- Indian Embassy in UAE celebrates India's rich textile legacy with 'Six Yards of India – The Saree Story' event in Abu Dhabi
- Goa signs Rs 5,000 crore MoU with ANVI for LPG terminal at Mormugao Port, project to create 2,450 jobs
- West Bengal to set up School of Magic and historical museum

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

Aspirant Queries

Aspirant: Does Affairscloud covers all the Current affairs topics related to examinations?

Affairscloud: We Guaranteed All the Important topics related to examination are covered in Our Daily CA content and Daily CA Quizzes.

Aspirant: Why is there a delayal in news?

Affairscloud: As some of the major news sites doesn't provide the required data on the exact day, we take extra time for important data to be presented to the aspirants on the examination basis to ensure nothing is missed.

Example: In 'Important Days' topics the International Organisations publish their reports and Rankings in the evenings, to make sure every data is covered, we delay the topics to the next day

Candidates appearing for Competitive Exams. Kindly Share the General Awareness questions, which asked in their respective exams to **"support@careerscloud.in"**

GA Questions Asked in Exams

- Affairscloud's Self Analysis for General Awareness Section

Most Trusted Source!!!!! Since 2014, nearly 85% of the questions in the General Awareness section on Bank Exams have been covered by Affairscloud@Careerscloud.

Copyright 2014-2026 @ AffairsCloud.com

CareersCloud
LEARN TO LEAD

Buy Current Affairs Course - 2026



Top Features

Daily: Toppers CA PDF, Daily CA Quiz, HandWritten Notes

Weekly: Weekly Top 60 Quiz, Weekly CA Content PDF

Monthly: Monthly CA Pocket PDF, Monthly CA Study PDF, Exam PDF, Banking & Economy PDF

Get 10% Discount **USE CODE A10**